

Cohesive Devices

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Writing

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LA04

Learning Intention

I am learning that cohesion can be created through the intentional use of repetition and word associations.

Success Criteria

- I can identify a cohesive device in a text.
- I can explain how repetition or word association links ideas.
- I can use cohesive devices in my own writing.

Link Your Ideas Together

Cohesion links ideas across sentences and paragraphs. Repeating a key word, or using related words (word association), helps a reader follow the topic smoothly.

Worked Example

The forest was silent. Among the trees, shadows grew long, and the forest seemed to hold its breath. ('forest' repeated; 'trees' and 'shadows' are word associations linking to the forest topic.)

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the repeated word that creates cohesion: *The ocean was calm. **The ocean** sparkled in the sun.*

True or False: Using only pronouns with no repetition always creates strong cohesion.

Name a word associated with 'ocean' (e.g. waves, tide). _____

Part B — Core Skills

Identify the cohesive device: *The storm was fierce. Lightning flashed and thunder roared through the storm clouds.*

Write a sentence continuing this topic using a word associated with 'mountain': *The mountain was steep.*

Explain why repeating a key word across paragraphs can help a reader.

Fix this choppy pair by adding a word association: *The river flowed fast. It was dangerous.*

Word Bank

cohesion • repetition • word association • link • topic • flow • connect ideas

Working Space — Write a Short Paragraph (3–4 sentences) Using Repetition or Word Association to Link Ideas

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Part C — Challenge: The Bushfire Recount

A Year 6 student wrote: "The bushfire spread quickly through the dry bush. Flames leapt between the trees, and smoke filled the sky above the fire."

- Q8. Identify the repeated word and 2 word associations that create cohesion in this recount.
- Q9. Rewrite the recount removing all repetition and word associations. Explain what is lost from the writing.
- Q10. Explain why cohesive devices like these are especially important in a longer piece of writing, such as a full recount or report.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: "The ocean" is repeated.

A2: False — while pronouns can help, too many with no repetition can make writing confusing; a balance of repetition and pronouns creates the strongest cohesion.

A3: Any reasonable word associated with ocean (e.g. waves, tide, sand) — teacher to check.

Answer Key — Part B

B1: The word 'storm' is repeated, creating cohesion (accept identifying 'lightning' and 'thunder' as word associations too).

B2: Any sentence using a mountain-associated word (e.g. "The climb up the rocky slope was tiring.") — teacher to check.

B3: Repeating a key word reminds the reader what the paragraph is still about, helping them follow the topic without getting confused, especially across longer pieces of writing.

B4: Any sentence adding a word association linked to 'river' (e.g. "The river flowed fast. The current was dangerous.") — teacher to check.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: Repeated word: "bushfire"/"fire". Word associations: "flames", "trees", "smoke" (accept any 2 reasonable associations).

C9: "It spread quickly through the dry area. Something leapt between them, and haze filled the sky above it." The writing loses clarity and becomes confusing, since the reader can no longer clearly tell what is being described throughout.

C10: In longer writing, readers can easily lose track of the topic across many sentences and paragraphs; cohesive devices help remind the reader what is being discussed and keep the whole piece feeling connected and easy to follow.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can identify cohesive devices in a text.

☐ I can use cohesive devices in my own writing.

☐ I can explain how they link ideas.